

Claims, Benefits & Appeals Operations Guide - 2026

Document ID	CLAIMS-OPS-2026
Plan Type	All Commercial Plans
Effective Date	2026-01-01
Policy Domain	Claims Operations
Status	Active

SECTION 1: BENEFIT VERIFICATION

Benefit verification provides information about eligibility, covered services, authorization requirements and benefit limits. Benefit verification is informational and is not a guarantee of payment.

SECTION 2: CLAIM SUBMISSION

Participating providers should submit clean claims within 180 calendar days from the date of service unless a provider agreement specifies a different filing limit.

SECTION 3: CLAIM ADJUDICATION

Claims are evaluated for member eligibility, covered benefits, authorization requirements, network status, coding accuracy, duplicate billing and applicable member cost share.

SECTION 4: DENIALS

When a claim is denied, the remittance or denial notice identifies the reason code and available next steps. Common causes include missing authorization, non-covered service, eligibility issues, duplicate claims and filing-limit failures.

SECTION 5: PROVIDER APPEALS

A provider appeal should be submitted within 60 calendar days from the date of the denial notice unless a contract or applicable regulation specifies a different timeframe. The appeal should include the claim identifier, reason for dispute and supporting documentation.

SECTION 6: AUDITABILITY

Operational decisions should retain the source policy, policy version, relevant section, decision timestamp and reviewer or system identifier to support traceability.

Training note: This document is synthetic and created only for AI/RAG training.